

Ava De La Cruz

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EDUCATION

Denison University | Granville, OH Aug 2024 – Current
B.S. in Computer Science | GPA: 3.81

SKILLS

Languages: Python, C++, SQL, JavaScript

Tools & Frameworks: React.js, Node.js, GitHub, Matplotlib, Pandas, ETC EOS Lighting Software

Foreign Languages: Proficient in Spanish

PROJECTS

Denilingo | Denison University Jan 2026 – Current

- Build and maintain frontend features for an AI-powered language learning platform that provides personalized feedback using OpenAI and LangChain, reducing professor grading time by ~6 hours per class
- Deployed a live system used by 30 students in an Intermediate Spanish course, hosting the application on AWS EC2 with an 8-entity relational database on AWS RDS

Jobbie Summer 2025

- Developed skills in open-source collaboration through GitHub workflows, including branching and pull requests

Stock Exchange Performance Analysis | Denison University Fall 2024

- Designed project in a team of 3 to analyze and visually output stock exchange data using Python (Pandas, Matplotlib)
- Ensured code maintainability and developed a suite of unit tests to validate functionality

WORK EXPERIENCE

Denison University

Sociology Research Assistant Jan 2026 – Current

- Conduct comparative analysis of university IRB policies related to international human subjects research
- Systematically code qualitative data to support cross-institutional faculty research and identify policy patterns

Community Advisor (Residential Advisor) Aug 2025 – Current

- Document student incidents accurately and clearly in accordance with university housing standards
- Balance priorities including administrative responsibilities, community-building, and resident support

Sustainability Fellow Sept 2024 – Current

- Coordinate with 20+ senior students regarding student-led compost program
- Pilot compost program in first-year residential halls by organizing outreach and monitoring participation

Computer Science Teaching Assistant Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

- Communicated Python and introductory computer science topics in office hours open to 108 students
- Reviewed and categorized ~20 assignments per week for Denison's intro CS course (CS 111)

Chicago Board of Education Jan 2023 – May 2025

Student Worker (Stage Crew Technician)

- Trained 30+ others in technical lighting programming skills; delegated tasks and assigned shifts to workers
- Supported directors and performers with lighting and sound design

LEADERSHIP AND INVOLVEMENT

Theatre Production | Denison University Sept 2024 – May 2025

- Operated and programmed lights for productions in collaborative setting to execute visual and technical elements
- Supported productions in roles including Assistant Lighting Designer, Board Operator, and Stage Manager, adapting to unexpected challenges in a fast-paced environment

HONORS & AWARDS

- Forbes B. Wiley Award (Denison University, Oct 2025)- for demonstrated excellence in computer science
- Dean's List (Fall 2024, Fall 2025)
- Denison Merit Scholarship Recipient
- Carson Scholarship and Recognized Carson Scholar- for community service and academic excellence
- Chicago Latino Caucus Foundation Scholarship- for leadership and academic achievement